

1750 ▶ 1770

“The heat which disappears in the conversion of water into vapor is not lost.”

Joseph Black, on latent heat

1753

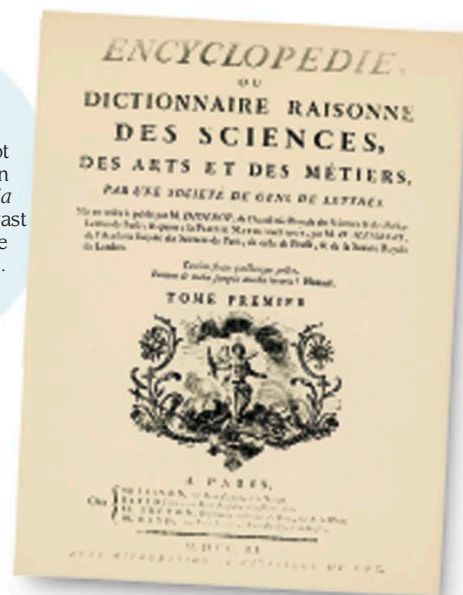
Citrus cure

Scurvy was a dreadful disease that killed thousands of sailors on long voyages. James Lind, a British naval surgeon, was able to show that it could be prevented by drinking lemon or lime juice. We now know that scurvy is caused by a lack of Vitamin C, which is found in all citrus fruits.



Sum of all knowledge

In 1751, French philosophers Denis Diderot and Jean d'Alembert began publishing the *Encyclopédie* (*Encyclopédie in French*), a vast work that aimed to include all the world's knowledge. They completed it in 20 years.



Title page of Volume 1 of the *Encyclopédie*



The 28-volume *Encyclopedia* contained 71,808 articles and 3,129 illustrations.



1750

1754

1758

1752

Bright spark

Future American statesman, Benjamin Franklin, risked death to prove that lightning is caused by electricity. He took his son to fly a kite in a thunderstorm, tying an iron key to the kite string. When lightning hit the kite, the key gave off a stream of sparks.



1754

Dense gas

Scottish chemist Joseph Black discovered a gas that is denser than air, and called it “fixed air.” We now know it as carbon dioxide. Black later discovered latent heat (the energy absorbed or released when a substance changes from a solid to a liquid state, or vice versa).



Marine chronometer

English clockmaker John Harrison built a chronometer, to be used at sea to measure longitude accurately. It proved a great aid to navigation (see pp.92–93).



Harrison's No. 4 chronometer, 1759